

अथ उत्तमचरितम्

अथ ध्यानम्

घण्टाशूलहलानि शङ्खमुसले चक्रं धनुः सायकं
हस्ताब्जैर्दधतीं घनान्तविलसच्छीतांशुतुल्यप्रभाम् ।
गौरीदेहसमुद्भवां त्रिजगतामाधारभूतां महा-
पूर्वामत्र सरस्वतीमनुभजे शुम्भादिदैत्यादिनीम् ॥

MEDITATION OF MAHĀSARASVATĪ

I meditate on the incomparable Mahāsarasvatī who holds in her (eight) lotus-like hands bell, trident, plough, conch, mace, discus, bow and arrows ; who is effulgent like the moon shining at the fringe of a cloud, who is the destroyer of Śumbha and other asuras, who issued forth from Pārvatī's body and is the substratum of the three worlds.

अथ पञ्चमोऽध्यायः

ॐ ऋषिरुवाच ॥ १ ॥

पुरा शुम्भनिशुम्भाभ्यामसुराभ्यां शचीपतेः ।
त्रैलोक्यं यज्ञभागाश्च हता मदबलाश्रयात् ॥ २ ॥

तावेव सूर्यतां तद्वदधिकारं तथैन्दवम् ।
कौबेरमथ याम्यं च चक्राते वरुणस्य च ॥ ३ ॥

तावेव पवनर्द्धिं च चक्रतुर्वह्निकर्म च ।
ततो देवा विनिर्धूता भ्रष्टराज्याः पराजिताः ॥ ४ ॥

1-2. The R̥ṣi said: Of yore Indra's (sovereignty) over the three worlds and his portion of the sacrifices were taken away by the asuras, S'umbha and Nisumbha,¹ by force of their pride and strength.

3. The two, themselves, took over likewise, the offices of the sun, the moon, Kubera, Yama, and Varuṇa.

4. They themselves exercised Vāyu's authority and Agni's duty. Deprived of their lordships and sovereignties, the devas were defeated.

1. According to the Vāmana-Purāṇa, S'umbha and Nis'umbha were born of Kas'yapa and his wife Danu.

हताधिकारास्त्रिदशस्ताभ्यां सर्वे निराकृताः ।
महासुराभ्यां तां देवीं संस्मरन्त्यपराजिताम् ॥ ५ ॥

तयास्माकं वरो दत्तो यथापत्सु स्मृताखिलाः ।
भवतां नाशयिष्यामि तत्क्षणात्परमापदः ॥ ६ ॥

इति कृत्वा मतिं देवा हिमवन्तं नगेश्वरम् ।
जग्मुस्तत्र ततो देवीं विष्णुमायां प्रतुष्टुवुः ॥ ७ ॥

देवा ऊचुः ॥ ८ ॥

नमो देव्यै महादेव्यै शिवायै सततं नमः ।
नमः प्रकृत्यै भद्रायै नियताः प्रणताः स्म ताम् ॥ ९ ॥

5. Deprived of their functions and expelled by these two great asuras, all the devas thought of the invincible Devī.

6. 'She had granted us the boon, "Whenever in calamities you think of me, that very moment I will put an end to all your worst calamities."'

7. Resolving thus, the devas went to Himavat, lord of the mountains, and there extolled the Devī, who is the illusive power of Viṣṇu.

8-9. The devas said :² 'Salutation to the Devī, to the Mahādevī. Salutation always to her who is ever

2. This is called a hymn to Aparājitā.

रौद्रायै नमो नित्यायै गौर्यै धात्र्यै नमो नमः ।
ज्योत्स्नायै चेन्दुरूपिण्यै सुखायै सततं नमः ॥ १० ॥

कल्याण्यै प्रणता वृद्ध्यै सिद्ध्यै कुर्मो नमो नमः ।
नैर्ऋत्यै भूमृतां लक्ष्म्यै शर्वाण्यै ते नमो नमः ॥ ११ ॥

दुर्गायै दुर्गपारायै सारायै सर्वकारिण्यै ।
ख्यात्यै तथैव कृष्णायै धूम्रायै सततं नमः ॥ १२ ॥

auspicious. Salutation to her who is the primordial cause and the sustaining power. With attention, we have made obeisance to her.

10. 'Salutation to her who is terrible, to her who is eternal. Salutation to Gaurī, the supporter (of the Universe). Salutation always to her who is of the form of the moon and moon-light and happiness itself.

11. 'We bow to her who is welfare; we make salutations to her who is prosperity and success. Salutation to the consort of S'iva who is herself the good fortune as well as misfortune of kings.

12. 'Salutation always to Durgā who takes one across in difficulties, who is essence, who is the author of everything; who is knowledge of discrimination; and who is blue-black as also smoke-like in complexion.

अतिसौम्यातिरौद्रायै नतास्तस्यै नमो नमः ।

नमो जगत्प्रतिष्ठायै देव्यै कृत्यै नमो नमः ॥ १३ ॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु विष्णुमायेति शब्दिता ।

नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥१४-१६॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु चेतनेत्यभिधीयते ।

नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥१७-१९॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु बुद्धिरूपेण संस्थिता ।

नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥२०-२२॥

13. 'We prostrate before her who is at once most gentle and most terrible; we salute her again and again. Salutation to her who is the support of the world. Salutation to the Devī who is of the form of volition.

14-16. 'Salutations again and again to the Devī who in all beings is called Viṣṇumāyā;

17-19. 'Salutations again and again to the Devī who abides in all being as consciousness;

20-22. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of intelligence;

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु निद्रारूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥२३-२५॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु क्षुधारूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥२६-२८॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु छायारूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥२९-३१॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु शक्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥३२-३४॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु तृष्णारूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥३५-३७॥

23-25. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of sleep ;

26-28. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of hunger ;

29-31. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of reflection ;

32-34. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of power ;

35-37. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of thirst ;

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु क्षान्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥३८-४०॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु जातिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥४१-४३॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु लज्जारूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥४४-४६॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु शान्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥४७-४९॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु श्रद्धारूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥५०-५२॥

38-40. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of patience;

41-43. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of genus;

44-46. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of modesty;

47-49. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of peace;

50-52. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of faith;

रौद्रायै नमो नित्यायै गौर्यै धात्र्यै नमो नमः ।
ज्योत्स्नायै चेन्दुरूपिण्यै सुखायै सततं नमः ॥ १० ॥

कल्याण्यै प्रणता वृद्ध्यै सिद्ध्यै कुर्मो नमो नमः ।
नैर्ऋत्यै भूमृतां लक्ष्म्यै शर्वाण्यै ते नमो नमः ॥ ११ ॥

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नमो जगत्प्रतिष्ठायै देव्यै कृत्यै नमो नमः ॥ १३ ॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु विष्णुमायेति शब्दिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥ १४-१६ ॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु चेतनेत्यभिधीयते ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥ १७-१९ ॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु बुद्धिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥ २०-२२ ॥

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 नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥२३-२५॥
 या देवी सर्वभूतेषु क्षुधारूपेण संस्थिता ।
 नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥२६-२८॥
 या देवी सर्वभूतेषु छाया रूपेण संस्थिता ।
 नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥२९-३१॥
 या देवी सर्वभूतेषु शक्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
 नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥३२-३४॥
 या देवी सर्वभूतेषु तृष्णारूपेण संस्थिता ।
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 नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥३८-४०॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु जातिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
 नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥४१-४३॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु लज्जारूपेण संस्थिता ।
 नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥४४-४६॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु शान्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
 नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥४७-४९॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु श्रद्धारूपेण संस्थिता ।
 नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥५०-५२॥

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या देवी सर्वभूतेषु कान्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।

नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥५३-५५॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु लक्ष्मीरूपेण संस्थिता ।

नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥५६-५८॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु वृत्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।

नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥५९-६१॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु स्मृतिरूपेण संस्थिता ।

नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥६२-६४॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु दयारूपेण संस्थिता ।

नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥६५-६७॥

53-55. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of loveliness ;

56-58. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of good fortune ;

59-61. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of activity ;

62-64. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of memory ;

65-67. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of compassion ;

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु तुष्टिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥६८-७०॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु मातृरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥७१-७३॥

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु भ्रान्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥७४-७६॥

इन्द्रियाणामधिष्ठात्री भूतानां चाखिलेषु या ।
भूतेषु सततं तस्यै व्याप्तिदेव्यै नमो नमः ॥ ७७ ॥

68-70. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of contentment ;

71-73. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of mother ;

74-76. 'To the Devī who abides in all beings in the form of error ;³

77. 'To the all-pervading Devī who constantly presides over the senses of all beings and (governs) all the elements ;

3. Truth and error are both obverse and reverse forms of the Goddess.

चितिरूपेण या कृत्स्नमेतद्व्याप्य स्थिता जगत् ।
नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै, नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥७८-८०॥

स्तुता सुरैः पूर्वमभीष्टसंश्रया-
त्तथा सुरेन्द्रेण दिनेषु सेविता ।
करोतु सा नः शुभहेतुरीश्वरी
शुभानि भद्राण्यभिहन्तु चापदः ॥ ८१ ॥

या साम्प्रतं चोद्धतदैत्यतापितै-
रस्माभिरीशा च सुरैर्नमस्यते ।
या च स्मृता तत्क्षणमेव हन्ति नः
सर्वापदो भक्तिविनम्रमूर्तिभिः ॥ ८२ ॥

78-80. 'Salutations again and again to her who, pervading this entire world, abides in the form of consciousness.

81. 'Invoked of yore by the devas for the sake of their desired object, and adored by the lord of the devas everyday, may she, the Īsvari, the source of all good, accomplish for us all auspicious things and put an end to our calamities!

82. 'And who ^{is} now again, revered by us, devas, tormented by arrogant asuras and who, called to mind by us obeisant with devotion, destroys this very moment all our calamities.'

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ ८३ ॥

एवं स्तवादियुक्तानां देवानां तत्र पार्वती ।

स्नातुमभ्याययौ तोये जाह्नव्या नृपनन्दन ॥ ८४ ॥

साब्रवीत्तान् सुरान् सुभ्रूर्भवद्भिः स्तूयतेऽत्र का ।

शरीरकोशतश्चास्याः समुद्भूताऽब्रवीच्छिव ॥ ८५ ॥

स्तोत्रं ममैतत्क्रियते शुम्भदैत्यनिराकृतैः ।

देवैः समेतैः समरे निशुम्भेन पराजितैः ॥ ८६ ॥

शरीरकोशाद्यत्तस्याः पार्वत्या निःसृताम्बिका ।

कौशिकीति समस्तेषु ततो लोकेषु गीयते ॥ ८७ ॥

83-84. The R̥ṣi said : O Prince, while the devas were thus engaged in praises and (other acts of adoration), Pārvatī came there to bathe in the waters of the Gangā.

85. She, the lovely-browed, said to those devas, 'Who is praised by you here ?' An auspicious goddess, sprung forth from her physical sheath, gave the reply :

86. 'This hymn is addressed to me by the assembled devas set at naught by the asura S'umbha and routed in battle by Nisuml̥ a.'

87. Because that Ambikā came out of Pārvatī's physical sheath (Kosa) she is glorified as Kausiki in all the worlds.

तस्यां विनिर्गतायां तु कृष्णाभृत्सापि पार्वती ।
कालिकेति समाख्याता हिमाचलकृताश्रया ॥ ८८ ॥

ततोऽम्बिकां परं रूपं विश्राणां सुमनोहरम् ।
ददर्श चण्डो मुण्डश्च भृत्यौ शुम्भनिशुम्भयोः ॥ ८९ ॥

ताभ्यां शुम्भाय चाख्याता सातीव सुमनोहरा ।
काप्यास्ते स्त्री महाराज भासयन्ती हिमाचलम् ॥ ९० ॥

नैव तादृक् क्वचिद्रूपं दृष्टं केनचिदुत्तमम् ।
ज्ञायतां काप्यसौ देवी गृह्यतां चासुरेश्वर ॥ ९१ ॥

88. After she had issued forth, Pārvatī became dark and was called Kālikā and stationed on mount Himālaya.

89. Then, Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa, two servants of S'umbha and Nisumbha, saw that Ambikā (Kausiki) bearing a surpassingly charming form.

90. They both told S'umbha, 'O King, a certain woman, most surpassingly beautiful, dwells there shedding lustre on Mount Himālaya.

91. 'Such supreme beauty was never seen by any one anywhere. Ascertain who that Goddess is and take possession of her, O Lord of the asuras !

स्त्रीरत्नमतिचार्वङ्गी द्योतयन्ती दिशस्त्विषा ।

सा तु तिष्ठति दैत्येन्द्र तां भवान् द्रष्टुमर्हति ॥ ९२ ॥

यानि रत्नानि मणयो गजाश्वादीनि वै प्रभो ।

त्रैलोक्ये तु समस्तानि साम्प्रतं भान्ति ते गृहे ॥ ९३ ॥

ऐरावतः समानीतो गजरत्नं पुरन्दरात् ।

पारिजाततरुश्चायं तथैवौचैःश्रवा हयः ॥ ९४ ॥

विमानं हंससंयुक्तमेतत्तिष्ठति तेऽङ्गणे ।

रत्नभूतमिहानीतं यदासीद्वेधसोऽद्भुतम् ॥ ९५ ॥

92. 'A gem among women, of exquisitely beautiful limbs, illuminating the quarters with her lustre, there she is, O lord of the daityas. You should see her.

93. 'O Lord, whatever jewels, precious stones, elephants, horses and others there are in the three worlds, they are all now in your house.

94. 'Airāvata, gem among elephants, has been brought away from Indra and so also this Parijāta tree and the horse Uccaiśravas.

95. 'Here stands in your courtyard the wonderful chariot yoked with swans, a wonderful gem (of its class). It has been brought here from Brahmā to whom it originally belonged.

निधिरेष महापद्मः समानीतो धनेश्वरात् ।

किञ्जलिकिनीं ददौ चाब्धिर्मालामम्लानपङ्कजाम् ॥ ९६ ॥

छत्रं ते वारुणं गेहे काञ्चनस्रावि तिष्ठति ।

तथाऽयं स्यन्दनवरो यः पुरासीत्प्रजापतेः ॥ ९७ ॥

मृत्योरुत्क्रान्तिदा नाम शक्तिरीशा त्वया हता ।

पाशः सलिलराजस्य भ्रातुस्तव परिग्रहे ॥ ९८ ॥

96. 'Here is the treasure named Mahāpadma⁴ brought from the lord of wealth. And the ocean gave a garland named kiñjalkinī⁵ made of unfading lotus flowers.

97. 'In your house stands the gold-showering umbrella of Varuṇa. And here is the excellent chariot that was formerly Prajāpati's.

98. By you, O Lord, Death's śakti weapon named Utkrāntida⁶ has been carried off. The noose of the ocean-king is in among your brother's possessions.

4. One of the nine treasures possessed by Kubera, the Lord of wealth.

5. Kiñjalkinī means 'full of (fine) filaments'.

6. Literally meaning 'giving an exit' or 'granting departure'. This weapon of Yama extracts the vital powers of creatures at the end of their lives.

निशुम्भस्याब्धिजाताश्च समस्ता रत्नजातयः ।
बह्विश्वापि ददौ तुभ्यमग्निशौचे च वाससी ॥ ९९ ॥

एवं दैत्येन्द्र रत्नानि समस्तान्याहृतानि ते ।
स्त्रीरत्नमेषा कल्याणी त्वया कस्मान्न गृह्यते ॥ १०० ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ १०१ ॥

निशम्येति वचः शुम्भः स तदा चण्डमुण्डयोः ।
प्रेषयास सुग्रीवं दूतं देव्या महासुरम् ॥ १०२ ॥

इति चेति च वक्तव्या सा गत्वा वचनान्मम ।
यथा चाभ्येति सम्प्रीत्या तथा कार्यं त्वया लघु ॥ १०३ ॥

99. 'Nisumbha has every kind of gem produced in the sea. Fire also gave you two garments which are purified by fire.

100. 'Thus, O Lord of asuras, all gems have been brought by you. Why this beautiful lady-jewel is not seized by you ?'

101-102. The R̥ṣi said : On hearing these words of Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa, S'umbha sent the great asura Sugrīva as messenger to the Devī.

103. He said : Go and tell her thus in my words and do the thing in such a manner that she may quickly come to me in love.

स तत्र गत्वा यत्रास्ते शैलोद्देशेऽतिशीमने ।
सा देवी तां ततः प्राह श्लक्ष्णं मधुरया गिरा ॥१०४॥

दूत उवाच ॥ १०५ ॥

देवि दैत्येश्वरः शुम्भस्त्रैलोक्ये परमेश्वरः ।
दूतोऽहं प्रेषितस्तेन त्वत्सकाशमिहागतः ॥ १०६ ॥

अव्याहताज्ञः सर्वासु यः सदा देवयोनिषु ।
निर्जिताखिलदैत्यारिः स यदाह शृणुष्व तत् ॥ १०७ ॥

मम त्रैलोक्यमखिलं मम देवा वशानुगाः ।
यज्ञभागानहं सर्वानुपाश्रामि पृथक् पृथक् ॥ १०८ ॥

104. He went there where the Devī was staying on a very beautiful spot in the mountain and spoke to her in fine and sweet words :

105-106. The messenger said, 'O Devī, S'umbha, lord of asuras, is the supreme sovereign of three worlds. Sent by him as messenger, I have come here to your presence.

107. 'Hearken to what has been said by him whose command is never resisted among the devas and who has vanquished all the foes of the asuras :

108. '(He says), "All the three worlds are mine and the devas are obedient to me. I enjoy all their shares in sacrifices separately.

त्रैलोक्ये वररत्नानि मम वक्ष्यान्यशेषतः ।

तथैव गजरत्नं च हतं देवेन्द्रवाहनम् ॥ १०९ ॥

क्षीरोदमथनोद्भूतमश्वरत्नं ममामरैः ।

उच्चैःश्रवससंज्ञं तत्प्रणिपत्य समर्पितम् ॥ ११० ॥

यानि चान्यानि देवेषु गन्धर्वेषूरगेषु च ।

रत्नभूतानि भूतानि तानि मय्येव शोभने ॥ १११ ॥

स्त्रीरत्नभूतां त्वां देवि लोके मन्यामहे वयम् ।

सा त्वमस्मानुपागच्छ यतो रत्नभुजो वयम् ॥ ११२ ॥

109-110. "All the choicest gems in the three worlds are in my possession; and so is the gem of elephants, Airāvata, the vehicle of the king of devas carried away be me. The devas themselves offered to me with salutations that gem of horses named Uccaisravas which arose at the churning of milk-ocean.

111. "O beautiful lady, whatever other rare objects there existed among the devas, gandharvas and nāgas are now with me.

112. "We look upon you, O Devī, as the jewel of womankind in the world. You who are such, come to me, since we are the enjoyers of the best objects.

मां वा ममानुजं वापि निशुम्भमुखिक्रमम् ।

भज त्वं चञ्चलापाङ्गि रत्नभृतासि वै यतः ॥ ११३ ॥

परमैश्वर्यमतुलं प्राप्स्यसे मत्परिग्रहात् ।

एतद्बुद्ध्या समालोच्य मत्परिग्रहतां व्रज ॥ ११४ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ ११५ ॥

इत्युक्ता सा तदा देवी गम्भीरान्तःस्मिता जगौ ।

दुर्गा भगवती भद्रा ययेदं धार्यते जगत् ॥ ११६ ॥

देव्युवाच ॥ ११७ ॥

113. "Take to me or to my younger brother Nisumbha of great prowess, O unsteady-eyed lady, for you are in truth a jewel.

114. "Wealth, great and beyond compare, you will get by marrying me. Think over this in your mind, and become my wife."

115-116. The Rṣi said: Thus told, Durgā the adorable and auspicious, by whom this universe is supported, then became serene and said.

117-118. The Devī said, 'You have spoken truth; nothing false has been uttered by you in this

सत्यमुक्तं त्वया नात्र मिथ्या किञ्चित्त्वयोदितम् ।
त्रैलोक्याधिपतिः शुम्भो निशुम्भश्चापि तादृशः ॥ ११८ ॥

किं त्वत्र यत्परिज्ञातं मिथ्या तत्क्रियते कथम् ।
श्रूयतामल्पबुद्धित्वात्प्रतिज्ञा या कृता पुरा ॥ ११९ ॥

यो मां जयति सङ्ग्रामे यो मे दर्पं व्यपोहति ।
यो मे प्रतिबलो लोके स मे भर्ता भविष्यति ॥ १२० ॥

तदागच्छतु शुम्भोऽत्र निशुम्भो वा महासुरः ।
मां जित्वा किं चिरेणात्र पाणिं गृह्णातु मे लघु ॥ १२१ ॥

matter. S'umbha is indeed the sovereign of the three worlds and likewise is also Nis'umbha.

119. 'But in this matter, how can that which has been promised be made false? Hear what promise I had made already out of foolishness.

120. 'He who defeats me in battle, removes my pride and is my match in strength in the world shall be my husband.

121. 'So let S'umbha come here then, or Nis'umbha the great asura. Vanquishing me here, let him soon take my hand in marriage. Why delay?'

दूत उवाच ॥ १२२ ॥

अवलिप्तासि मैवं त्वं देवि ब्रूहि ममाग्रतः ।

त्रैलोक्ये कः पुमांस्तिष्ठेदग्रे शुम्भनिशुम्भयोः ॥ १२३ ॥

अन्येषामपि दैत्यानां सर्वे देवा न वै युधि ।

तिष्ठन्ति सम्मुखे देवि किं पुनः स्त्री त्वमेकिका ॥ १२४ ॥

इन्द्राद्याः सकला देवास्तस्थुर्येषां न संयुगे ।

शुम्भादीनां कथं तेषां स्त्री प्रयास्यसि सम्मुखम् ॥ १२५ ॥

सा त्वं गच्छ मयैवोक्ता पार्श्वं शुम्भनिशुम्भयोः ।

केशकर्षणनिर्धृतगौरवा मा गमिष्यसि ॥ १२६ ॥

122. The messenger said, 'O Devī, you are haughty. Talk not so before me, which male in the three worlds will stand before S'umbha and Nisumbha?

124. 'All the devas verily cannot stand face to face with even the other asuras in battle. Why mention you, O Devī, a single woman ?

125. 'Indra and all other devas could not stand in battle against S'umbha and other demons, how will you, a woman face them ?

126. 'On my word itself, you go to S'umbha and Nisumbha. Let it not be that you go to them with your dignity lost by being dragged by your hair.'

देव्युवाच ॥ १२७ ॥

एवमेतद् बली शुम्भो निशुम्भश्चातिवीर्यवान् ।
किं करोमि प्रतिज्ञा मे यदनालोचिता पुरा ॥ १२८ ॥

स त्वं गच्छ मयोक्तं ते यदेतत्सर्वमादृतः ।
तदाचक्ष्वासुरेन्द्राय स च युक्तं करोतु यत् ॥ १२९ ॥

इति श्रीमार्कण्डेयपुराणे सावर्णिके मन्वन्तरे देवीमाहात्म्ये
देव्या दूतसंवादो नाम पञ्चमोऽध्यायः ॥ ५ ॥

127-128. The Devī said, 'Yes, it is; S'umbha is strong and so is Nis'umbha exceedingly heroic! What can I do since there stands my ill-considered vow taken long ago ?

129. 'Go back, and tell the lord of asuras carefully all this that I have said ; let him do whatever he considers proper.'

Here ends the fifth chapter called 'Devī's conversation with the Messenger' of Devī-māhātmya
in Mārkaṇḍeyapurāṇa during the period
of Sāvartī, the Manu.

